



Door Knocking – Personal, Direct, and Powerful Lead Generation

Introduction to Door Knocking

This lesson explores door knocking as one of the most underrated, yet powerful, unpaid marketing strategies in real estate. It's a personal, face-to-face approach that helps you build real trust and uncover off-market deals before other investors even know they exist.

You'll learn when and how to use this strategy effectively, how to approach homeowners respectfully, and what tools and practices help you stay organized and safe. Most importantly, you'll walk away ready to take immediate action with a simple challenge designed to get you in the field.

What to Expect and How It Works

This lesson covers:

- What door knocking is and why it still works today
- When and where to use this strategy for the best results
- How to identify the right properties and owners to target
- What to bring, what to say, and how to stay safe
- How to track your efforts and follow up consistently
- A weekend challenge to help you get started in the real world

Why Use Door Knocking?

- You go directly to the source—no competition or bidding wars
- You discover off-market opportunities before others do
- Personal contact builds faster trust than any email or ad
- Owners may be open to selling but haven't listed publicly

 Example: A single knock and respectful conversation has led many investors to life-changing deals—ones that started with no budget, just courage and follow-through.



📌 When Should You Use It?

Door knocking is especially effective when:

- The property fits your buy box and is within driving distance
- You see visible signs of distress (boarded windows, overgrown lawns, etc.)
- The owner is absentee, in preforeclosure, or has held the property long-term
- You want to bypass traditional marketing and speak directly to decision-makers

📌 How to Choose Which Doors to Knock

To build your list:

- Use Deal Driven to filter by property type, ownership status, and location
- Or drive neighborhoods (Driving for Dollars) and spot distress manually
- Record your findings using spreadsheets or mapping apps
- Verify ownership using public records or tax assessor sites
- If no one answers, follow up with direct mail or skip tracing

📌 Best Practices for Beginners

- Bring a simple one-pager or business card with your contact info
- Dress casual but professional—approachable and non-threatening
- Avoid backpacks or anything that feels intimidating
- Use a friendly, natural opener (e.g., “Hi, I’m looking to buy in this area...”)
- If rejected, thank them, leave a card, and keep it positive
- If open to talk, take your time and focus on building rapport

📌 Track Everything

- Keep a record of every address you visit
- Note conversation outcomes and any key homeowner info
- Use tools like Google Sheets, REsimpli, or Podio for tracking
- Follow up on warm leads and set reminders for future contact

📌 Organized tracking ensures no opportunity slips through the cracks.

Safety First

- Only knock during daylight hours
 - Stand a few steps back after knocking to create a safe distance
 - Go in pairs if possible, and always let someone know your route
 - Trust your gut—if something feels off, leave the area
 - Your safety is more important than any deal
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Key Takeaways

- Door knocking creates real opportunities through real conversations
 - Success comes from consistency, preparation, and empathy
 - It's not about scripts—it's about human connection
 - The right approach builds trust, even in short interactions
 - One genuine conversation can lead to a powerful breakthrough
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Action Steps – Your Door Knocking Challenge

Over the next few days:

1. Choose a local neighborhood that fits your buy box
2. Identify 10 properties with signs of distress or from your Deal Driven list
3. Spend a few hours this weekend knocking on those doors
4. Focus on having one genuine conversation—not closing ten deals
5. Track every visit, follow up, and stay engaged

 Door knocking takes courage—but that first knock could change everything. Take the step, then share your story with the Partner Driven community.